MARUTI SUZUKI JIMNY

The much-awaited 5-door, 4-seater Jimny was revealed at the Auto Expo. The sub-4m SUV uses a ladder frame chassis and at the same time sports proper 4wd hardware. Power is sent to the rear wheels using a 5-speed manual or a 4-speed AT. Powering the Jimny is the 1.5-litre K15B petrol engine. Power output is rated at 104bhp and torque on tap is 134Nm. The Jimny comes with a 208 litre boot and Maruti Suzuki will offer six airbags. The Jimny will be available in two variants and be sold via the brand's premium Nexa chain. Bookings are open; prices are to be announced later this year.



ent, notable absentees included Mahindra, Honda, Renault and Nissan, among the mass market manufacturers. Virtually all luxury car makers gave the event a miss, Lexus being the exception. Most major players in the two-wheeler industry were missing too, although new age, non-legacy firms turned up to showcase their electric two-wheelers.

Given the big question marks about the relevance of motor shows globally in this day and age, the Auto Expo 2023 was a big success. But motor shows, as we have known them, are definitely becoming a thing of the past. Even many of the legacy players, including Hyundai, showcased technology and electronics as much as they did future mobility and cars.

In terms of vehicles consumers can actually get their hands on, standouts included the electric Hyundai Ioniq 5 that went on sale at the Expo itself and the long-awaited Maruti Suzuki Jimny, for which bookings have now opened. A number of dazzling designs, some road-ready while others still concepts of the shape of cars to come, filled out the show. ■

–Yogendra Pratap

Photographs by **GURDEEP BHALLA**

★ SHOW ★ STOPPERS



TATA AVINYA GEN 3

The Avinya made its debut back in 2022 and now it has arrived in India to mesmerise crowds. It is based on a brand new EV-centric skateboard platform. It is also the brand's first Gen 3 electric vehicle and is slated for a 2025 launch. The Avinya is expected to offer a range in excess of 500km. The battery used will support an ultra-fast charge capability, in line with the infrastructure evolution, pumping a minimum 500km range in under 30 minutes. Being a concept, designers have taken several liberties, including the butterfly doors. However, we expect the production version to feature regular doors.

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR



KIA EV9

The Kia EV9 is slated to go into production this year. Measuring 4,929mm in length and with a wheelbase of 3,100mm, the EV9 is based on Kia's Electric Global Modular Platform. This then could be the brand's flagship electric SUV. Apart from looking good, the EV9 also boasts a host of technical advancements. We hear that there will be a 77.4kWh battery pack that will power it. The more revolutionary part is that the 800V electrical architecture will allow for fast charging capabilities of up to 350kW. A fast charge of the battery from 10 to 80 per cent takes around 20 minutes. Further, there will be a dual motor version and this means that the production version of the EV9 will come with AWD capabilities.